



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

Grassroots football · U12 · U15 · U17 · Greater Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

EVENT PROPOSAL · 36-TEAM EDITION · OCTOBER 2026

Growfit Youth Cup 36-Team Edition

A two-day grassroots tournament for **36 teams** (12 each in U12, U15 and U17) from across Greater Durban. Entry fees are in line with other Durban youth cups (R700 to R1,200), and **each division winner takes home a sports-equipment voucher of up to R5,000**, up to 4 times their entry fee. Free entry for spectators. The event pays for itself from entries and the family zone.

36 teams

12 per age group · about 500 young players

75 matches

Over two days, on four pitches at one venue (U12 on a 9-a-side pitch)

Up to R5,000

Winner's voucher in each division.
Free entry for spectators

Contact

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Event

Date: [two days, school holidays or a long weekend]
Venue: [venue, Greater Durban]
Sanctioned through: [GDLFA / SAFA eThekwin]

1 The idea

During the school holidays, grassroots players in Durban have few chances to play competitive football. The Growfit Youth Cup fills that gap. It is a two-day tournament for **36 U12, U15 and U17** teams, run to the same standards Growfit applies every week: qualified referees, first aid on site, safeguarding, and every child getting meaningful game time.

3

Age groups: U12, U15, U17

12

Teams per age group

3+

Matches guaranteed per team

**R700–
R1,200**

Entry fee per team, by age group

Format

ELEMENT	DETAIL
Format	Three groups of four per division. Every team plays three group matches. The top two in each group and the two best 3rd-placed teams go to the quarter-finals, then the semi-finals and the final.
Match length	U12: 2 × 10 min (9-a-side). U15 and U17: 2 × 12 min (11-a-side). Played on four pitches at one venue (U12 on a 9-a-side pitch). Final lengths are confirmed with the sanctioning body.
Squads	Up to 14 players per team, with rolling substitutions. SAFA/LFA-registered players only, with a team list and age verification at check-in.
Awards	Each division winner gets a trophy, gold medals and a sports-equipment voucher (U12 R3,000 · U15 R4,000 · U17 R5,000). Runners-up get silver medals and a match ball. Player of the Tournament, Golden Glove and Top Scorer in every division. Every player gets a certificate (Section 4).
Extras	A coaches' breakfast and short coaching talk. Match filming if the academy camera is in place. A family zone with food vendors.

Why Growfit can deliver it

Growfit is a registered NPC running three age groups in the Greater Durban Football League. It has eight adopted policies, including Child Protection & Safeguarding and Injury & Medical Emergency. Every player is registered with SAFA and every coach is CPR Part B checked. Our weekly matchday routine (registration checks, attendance, first aid, communication with parents) is the same routine a tournament needs, only bigger.

2 What participating clubs get

Quality football

At least three competitive matches per team over a weekend, against opponents of similar age from across Durban. That is more game time than a month of league weekends.

Priced like other Durban cups

U12 R700 · U15 R1,000 · U17 R1,200 per team, close to established tournaments such as the Sonani Heritage Cup. That covers qualified referees, first aid, water, medals and certificates, and a winner's voucher of **4–4 times the entry fee**.

Safe and well run

Qualified referees, a first-aid station, a named safety officer, a safeguarding lead and a lost-child point. Parents know what to expect.

Visibility for players

Individual awards, certificates and match footage (where available) help players with trials and school sports programmes. Scouts and school coaches are invited.

Coach development

A coaches' breakfast with a short talk (e.g. "Game-time for every player") and a chance to connect with other grassroots coaches.

Recognition

Each club is named in the programme, on social media and in the results sheet sent to all participants.

3 What sponsors get

The Cup **pays for itself** from entry fees and the family zone (Section 7). Sponsorship makes it bigger: a **Voucher Partner** can lift the winners' prizes to R6,000 / R8,000 / R10,000, and a **Kit Prize Partner** adds a new match kit for every division winner (see Section 4).

PACKAGE	INCLUDES	VALUE
Headline Partner (1)	Event named "Growfit Youth Cup presented by [Partner] ". Logo on banners, medals ribbon, certificates and all posts. Presents the trophies. Branded stall in the family zone. B-BBEE socio-economic development letter.	R15,000
Pitch Partner (3)	A pitch named after the partner (" [Partner] Pitch"), with pitch-side banner and mentions on the PA and social media.	R3,000 each
Medals & Awards Partner (1)	Logo on medal ribbons and certificates. Presents the individual awards.	R5,000
Refreshment Partner (in kind)	Provides water, fruit or snacks for players. Sampling stand and logo on the programme.	In kind
Community Supporter	Any amount or service: printing, transport, gazebos, PA system, first-aid supplies. Thanked in the programme and on social media.	Any

Growfit does not accept sponsorship from alcohol or tobacco/vaping brands. Licensed betting partners are welcome. On children's kit, medals and certificates their branding is limited to name and logo, with no betting promotions aimed at under-18s.

4 Prizes worth playing for

We studied what makes Durban youth cups attractive. The Sonani Heritage Cup charges R500–R1,000 to enter and gives each age-group winner a voucher of R5,000–R12,000. The Siyakhula U15 Cup gave its winners R10,000 in equipment and a new match kit. The lesson: **clubs enter for one big, clear prize for the winner**, not small amounts spread over many places. So that is what we do.

DIVISION	ENTRY FEE	WINNER'S VOUCHER	PRIZE ÷ ENTRY	WITH PARTNERS
U12	R700	R3,000	4.3×	R6,000 + kit
U15	R1,000	R4,000	4.0×	R8,000 + kit
U17	R1,200	R5,000	4.2×	R10,000 + kit

Every division, every edition

Winners	Trophy, gold medals and the sports-equipment voucher above, presented on a giant voucher board
Runners-up	Silver medals and a match ball for the club
Player of the Tournament	Trophy
Golden Glove · Top Scorer	Trophy each
Every player	Participation certificate. Scouts and school coaches invited

Vouchers are bought from a sports retailer at a club discount and go to the **club**, never to children. Prizes are **fixed and guaranteed** once the go/no-go minimum (33 teams) is reached. Strict eligibility: SAFA/LFA cards and ID or birth certificates are checked at check-in, and a team that fields an ineligible player forfeits its prize.

How partners make the prizes bigger

Voucher Partner (sports retailer)	Matches our vouchers with store credit, so winners get the "With partners" amounts above. Named on every prize ("Prizes by [Store] "), with a stall in the family zone where winners can redeem.
Kit Prize Partner	A new match kit for each division winner, with your logo on it. (Hollywoodbets did exactly this at the Siyakhula U15 Cup.)
Division Prize Partner	Adds R5,000 or more to one division. The division is named " [Partner] U15 Cup", and you present the prize on stage.

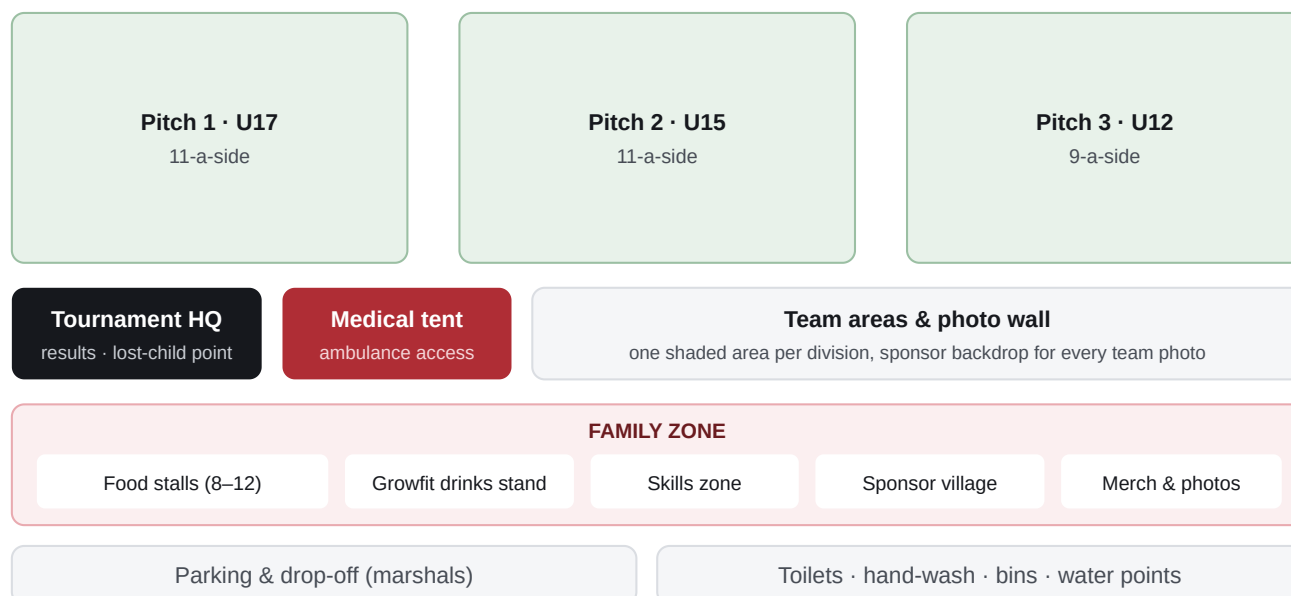
5 How partners are showcased on the day

We showcase partners the way established tournaments do, and we make sure every partner's investment is seen, photographed and reported.

- ✓ **Posters & social graphics:** a sponsor logo strip on every poster, fixture list, results graphic and story
- ✓ **Photo wall:** every team, winner and VIP photo is taken in front of a backdrop with your logo
- ✓ **Pitch-side:** banners, flags and named pitches (" **[Partner]** Pitch")
- ✓ **Stage & PA:** hourly mentions by the MC, and partners present the prizes
- ✓ **Sponsor village:** a stall or gazebo in the family zone for sampling, offers and sign-ups
- ✓ **VIP tent:** partners and their guests are hosted for the finals and prize-giving
- ✓ **Live coverage & take-home items:** posts, stories and a highlight reel with partner end-cards, plus medal ribbons, certificates and the programme kept by ~500 families. Media invited
- ✓ **Post-event report:** attendance, reach, photos of your branding and the finances, within 30 days

6 Event day: site, family zone & stalls

Entry for spectators is **free**. A big, relaxed crowd is what makes the day work for families, stall-holders and sponsors. The family zone is where the event earns its extra income.



Indicative layout for one venue, with a 4th pitch for U12, to be adapted. Medical access and the ambulance route stay clear all day. Stalls sit away from the pitches and the team areas.

Choosing the venue

The budget assumes **school or club grounds at a community rate (about R3,000 per venue per day)**. Municipal stadiums can cost far more: eThekwin's Chatsworth Stadium tariff rose to R13,240. A stadium is only worth it for the finals, and only if a sponsor pays. The venue needs 4 pitches (3 full-size plus a 9-a-side area) and secure overnight storage, toilets and water, parking, shade, a secure perimeter, ambulance access, permission for outside food vendors, and a location on taxi routes.

VENUE	WHY
Northwood Crusaders Sports Club , Durban North	Fields for hire for sports events, 10 minutes from North Crest Primary. A clubhouse and parking. Ask whether outside food stalls are allowed alongside the club bar and catering.
Siripat Sports Grounds , Reservoir Hills	Proven grassroots venue: the Siyakhula U15 Cup (AmaZulu Community Trust, Hollywoodbets, SAFA eThekwin) was played here.
North Crest Primary + a nearby school	Our partner school's field for U12 and the family zone, with a nearby high-school field for U15 and U17. Lowest cost, and good for the North Crest community, but two sites are harder to run.
UKZN sports grounds (Westville / Howard College)	Several fields and a prestige setting: they hosted the 2025 National Schools Football Championship (U15). A good step up for the High Stakes Edition, if the rate suits.
Sugar Ray Xulu (Clermont) / Princess Magogo (KwaMashu)	Municipal stadiums used for youth tournaments. Best for a sponsored finals day , not the whole event.

Stalls & family-zone income

STALL / ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS	FEE / INCOME
Food stalls (10)	Hot food: kotas, boerewors rolls, pap & meat, vetkoek, fruit. One stall per food type where possible, to avoid price wars. Booked and paid 2 weeks before.	R600 for both days
General & merch stalls (6)	Sportswear, accessories, sweets, small local businesses.	R450 each
Growfit drinks & water stand	Run by parent volunteers. The only seller of cold drinks and water , so food stalls sell food only. Ice and stock are bought in advance, and prices are displayed.	~R7,000 profit
Skills zone	"Beat the Keeper": R10 for 3 shots against a Growfit goalkeeper, with small donated prizes. Also a free ball-skills challenge for little ones.	~R2,800 net
Programme adverts	A5 match programme with fixtures, rules and the prize table. 12 local-business adverts.	12 × R300
Photographer	An invited photographer sells team and action photos to families and pays Growfit 20% commission (not counted in the budget).	Bonus
Sponsor village	Gazebos for partners: sampling, offers and sign-ups. Included in sponsor packages.	In packages

Stall-holder rules

- ✓ Booking form and full payment 2 weeks before. A refund is given if the event is cancelled.
- ✓ Food sellers must hold the food-safety certificate and trading permission required by eThekweni (e.g. a Certificate of Acceptability for food premises).
- ✓ No alcohol, no glass, no tobacco or vape sales, and no energy drinks sold to children.
- ✓ Each gas stall has a fire extinguisher. Generators are kept away from the crowd. Stall-holders bring their own power.
- ✓ Each stall clears its own area. Bins are provided, and the site is left clean by 17:00.

Run of show

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
Day 1: group stage	
06:30	Site set-up: pitches, HQ, medical tent, team areas, photo wall, signage. Stall-holders set up by 08:15
07:45	Team check-in: team sheets, registration cards and ID checks, wristbands. Referees' and coaches' briefing at 08:00
08:30	Group stage on 4 pitches in 30-minute slots: 54 group matches by about 15:30. Results posted at HQ and online after every round
16:00	Knockout draw published on WhatsApp and social media. Site secured overnight
Day 2: knockouts & finals (Same venue)	
08:30	Quarter-finals in all three divisions
11:00	Semi-finals
13:30	Finals, staggered: U12, then U15, then U17, so the crowd can watch all three
15:00	Prize-giving on stage: trophies, medals, giant voucher boards, individual awards, sponsor presentations
16:00	Stalls close, site cleared and handed back

Tie-breaks: group points, then goal difference, goals scored, head-to-head, then penalties. Drawn knockout matches go straight to penalties (3 each, then sudden death). A team more than 10 minutes late forfeits 3–0. Reserve teams are kept on a waiting list.

Volunteer roster (~27 people)

TEAM	PEOPLE	DUTIES
HQ & results	3	Fixtures, results board, social updates, PA announcements
Check-in & accreditation	3	Team sheets, ID checks, wristbands
Pitch marshals	6	2 per pitch: ball retrieval, keeping spectators back from the touchline, timing
Drinks stand	4	Sales, stock and cash (two people always count the cash)
Skills zone	2	Beat the Keeper, little ones' challenge
Parking & entrance	3	Drop-off, parking, keeping the ambulance route clear
Safeguarding & lost-child point	2	Led by the safeguarding lead
Clean-up & stall liaison	4	Bins, stall check-in, end-of-day clean-up

What could go wrong, and the plan

Rain or lightning	Matches stop for lightning ("30-30" rule). If more than 2 hours are lost: shortened matches, then a rain date agreed with the venue. Entry fees carry over to the new date.
Heat	Shade at team areas, water points, drinks breaks at half-time and in hot weather, lighter warm-ups.
A team doesn't arrive	A reserve team from the waiting list takes the place. Otherwise the match is a 3–0 walkover and the schedule holds.
A referee doesn't arrive	One standby referee is booked for the whole day.
Disputes	A 3-person tournament committee rules quickly, with no appeals on the day. Zero tolerance for abuse of referees.
Injury	Paramedic or qualified first-aid standby, with the ambulance route kept clear. Concussion rule: "if in doubt, sit them out".

7 Budget: balanced without sponsors or a gate fee

Planning estimates, to be updated with real quotes. Costs include all prizes. **No sponsorship and no spectator charge are counted.** Shown at full capacity (36 teams) and at the go/no-go minimum (33 teams), where family-zone income is also cut by 15%.

Costs

ITEM	36 TEAMS	33 TEAMS
Referees (R150 per match) + assistant referees for finals	12,250	10,900
Venue (2 venue-days × R3,000)	6,000	6,000
First-aid standby (2 × R2,500)	5,000	5,000
Security & marshals (2 × R1,000)	2,000	2,000
Drinking water for players	4,300	4,000
Trophies & medals	3,000	3,000
Gazebos, tables & PA	1,500	1,500
Event liability insurance	1,800	1,800
Programme, banners & printing	1,000	1,000
Admin, safety plan & permits	1,000	1,000
Participation certificates	600	600
Contingency (10%)	3,800	3,700
Winners' vouchers (R12,000 face value, bought with a ~15% club discount)	10,200	10,200
Runners-up: 1 match ball per division	900	900
Total costs	R53,350	R51,600

Income

SOURCE	36 TEAMS	33 TEAMS
Entry fees (R700 U12 · R1,000 U15 · R1,200 U17)	34,800	31,900
Food stalls (both days) (10 × R600)	6,000	5,100
General & merch stalls (both days) (6 × R450)	2,700	2,300
Growfit drinks & water stand (profit)	7,000	6,000
Skills zone (net)	2,800	2,400
Programme adverts (12 × R300)	3,600	3,100
Total income	R56,900	R50,800

Result: +R3,550 at 36 teams · –R800 at 33 teams. At the minimum, the gap is smaller than the R3,700 contingency already in the costs, so the event still breaks even unless something goes wrong. Any surplus goes to the academy's player-support fund. Sponsorship comes on top.

Go / no-go (6 weeks before)

- At least 33 teams entered and paid
- At least 6 food stalls booked and paid
- Venue, referees and first aid booked in writing
- Sanction from the LFA/region received

If these aren't met, the event runs as the next size down with that edition's prizes, or is postponed with full refunds.

8 Safety, safeguarding & compliance

AREA	HOW IT IS HANDLED
Sanctioning	The tournament is registered with the Greater Durban LFA / SAFA eThekweni Region, and their rules and referee appointments are followed.
Event safety (SASREA)	The event's risk category is confirmed with the municipality and SAPS under the Safety at Sports and Recreational Events Act. In all cases: a named safety officer, a written safety plan (crowd, parking, emergency medical, evacuation) and a briefing for all marshals.
Medical	Paramedic or qualified first-aid standby all day. Each team submits medical and emergency details. Concussion protocol: "if in doubt, sit them out". The nearest hospital route is in the safety plan.
Safeguarding	A named safeguarding lead. Team officials are accredited and wear tags, and only accredited adults are allowed in player areas. Lost-child point, no changing-room access for spectators, and a clear process for reporting concerns.
Photos & filming (POPIA)	Entry form confirms each club holds media consent for its players. Filming signage at the venue. Players without consent are not featured. Footage is shared only with the player's own club.
Weather & heat	Shaded areas, water points and drinks breaks in hot weather. A lightning and severe-weather stop rule. A rain-date plan is agreed with the venue.
Discipline & fair play	Code of conduct for players, officials and parents. A tournament committee rules on disputes. Zero tolerance for abuse of referees.
Money	Entry and stall fees by EFT only, with reference = team or stall name. Drinks-stand and skills-zone takings by SnapScan where possible, and any cash is counted by two people and banked within 2 working days. Income and spending are reported to sponsors within 30 days.

9 Event team

ROLE	WHO	MAIN TASKS
Tournament Director	Buhle Madlala	Overall lead, sponsors, sanctioning, referees
Competitions & Registration	Khaya Madlala	Entries, team lists, age checks, fixtures and results
Operations & Equipment	Sphe Mlotshwa	Venue layout, equipment, marshals, vendors
Safety Officer	[name]	Safety plan, first-aid liaison, emergency response
Safeguarding Lead	[name]	Accreditation, lost-child point, reporting concerns
Volunteers (12–15)	Parents & senior players	Pitch marshals, results runners, check-in, family zone

10 Timeline

WHEN	MILESTONE
12 weeks before	Date and venue provisionally booked. Sanction application to the LFA/region. Sponsor approaches start.
10 weeks before	Entry pack and invitation sent to clubs, with LFA endorsement on the poster. Stall bookings open . Voucher Partner approached. Event categorisation started with the municipality and SAPS.
6 weeks before	Go/no-go decision . Referees, first aid, marquee and toilets confirmed.
3 weeks before	Entries close. Fixtures drawn and published. Volunteer roster done. Medals ordered.
1 week before	Safety briefing. Team lists and medical forms received. Programme printed.
Event days	Day 1: check-in and group stage. Day 2: quarter-finals, semi-finals, finals and prize-giving (Section 6).
2–4 weeks after	Results, photos (consented) and thank-you to all clubs. Sponsor report with reach, attendance and finances.

11 How we will measure success

≥ 33

teams entered (36 target)

≥ 3

matches for every team

0

serious safety or
safeguarding incidents

≥ 80%

of clubs say they'd return
(post-event survey)

Our goal is to make the Growfit Youth Cup a **twice-yearly fixture** (June/July and December holidays) that grassroots clubs in Durban look forward to, and that grows with its sponsors.

Get involved. Clubs can enter with the form on the next page. Sponsors and supporters can contact **[name, phone, email]** .

Growfit Youth Cup: team entry form

One form per team. Send to **[email]** by **[closing date]** with proof of payment.

Club name

Age group

☐ U12 ☐ U15 ☐ U17

Affiliation (LFA / league)

Head coach name

Head coach phone / email

Second team official

Emergency contact on the day

Number of players (max 14)

Declarations by the club

- ☐ All players are registered with SAFA / our LFA and are within the age group.
- ☐ We hold parent/guardian consent for each player to take part, and medical/emergency details for each player will be brought on the day.
- ☐ We hold photo/media consent for players who may be filmed or photographed, and we will tell organisers about any player who must not be filmed.
- ☐ Our officials hold valid police/CPR Part B clearance and will follow the tournament code of conduct.

Payment

Entry fee per team: **U12 R700 · U15 R1,000 · U17 R1,200**, by EFT to **[bank, account name, account number, branch code]**. Reference: **[club name + age group]**. Refunded in full if the event does not go ahead.

Signed for the club

Name: _____

Role: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Received by Growfit

Name: _____

Payment confirmed: ☐

Date: ____ / ____ / ____